

Jewish Parents, Not Bias Keep Jews Out of Baseball, Says Andy Cohen

MINNEAPOLIS —(JTA)— Racial and religious prejudice is “alien to the baseball diamond” and it is parental objections and not bias which are responsible for the relative lack of Jewish players in professional baseball.

That’s the opinion of Andy Cohen, who for nine seasons was a favorite of Minneapolis ball fans as the talented second baseman of the Minneapolis Millers. Now living in El Paso, Tex., Cohen revisited Minneapolis as the guest of honor at the 13th annual Baseball Boosters Dinner.

Cohen, who played with the New York Giants, is returning to the major leagues this season as an infield coach with the Philadelphia Phillies. He said that he had never encountered as much as a wisecrack about his Jewishness in 30 years of association with the sport.

“An athlete’s ability, not his race, color or religion, is the factor that counts in baseball,” he said. “A racing fast ball, not racism, wins ballgames.”

Jewish parents, he contended, “frown on their sons going into baseball” and encourage them to enter business and the professions instead.” “Jewish parents, not the sport, have closed the door to increased numbers of Jewish athletes playing professional ball.”

Stamp Honoring Herzl Introduced in House

WASHINGTON —(JTA)— Rep. Seymour Halpern, New York Republican, introduced a bill in the House to create a U. S. postage stamp in the “champions of liberty” series, commemorating the 100th anniversary of the birth of Theodor Herzl.

The issue would be concurrent with the celebration of Dr. Herzl’s centennial year. Rep. Halpern said the name of the Zionist pioneer would occupy a place side by side with such liberators as Bolivar, Kossuth, and San Martin.

Two Italian Youths Jailed for Painting Swastikas

ROME — (JTA) — Two young men found guilty of stealing and hanging from a tree a statue representing a Jewish warrior and painting swastikas were sentenced to 40-day jail terms. A third boy was found guilty but released because he was a minor.

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